

Jugnoo Uses Open Source to Dominate the Auto-rickshaw Aggregator Space

Chandigarh based Jugnoo is using open source technologies to upgrade the Indian urban transport scene through an advanced app-based model. In the process, it is helping to enhance the earnings of hundreds and thousands of auto-rickshaw drivers in the country.

As the world is moving towards digitalisation, the Indian transport system is becoming smarter. Many app-based aggregators are stepping into the market to transform the traditional commuting options across the country. Jugnoo is a Chandigarh based startup that has picked some open source technologies not just to grow bigger in the world of app-based transporters but also to reform Indian transport, as a whole.

"Open source provides us the ability to use the software fairly quickly without getting into formal business software purchase processes. In startups, where speed is the king, this is something that is very helpful when trying out something new," said Chinmay Agarwal, co-founder and CTO of Jugnoo, in an exclusive conversation with OSFY.

Agarwal's team has used some open source frameworks to design the core structure of Jugnoo, with an aim to help auto-rickshaw drivers. Additionally, there is the Elastic search engine support to help developers fix bugs within the Jugnoo apps.

The company recently ventured into the machine learning field and has introduced a bot that offers the auto-rickshaw booking service via Facebook Messenger. The bot comes through some API integration and enables real-time notifications using the messaging platform.

In addition to its newer features for some advanced smartphone users like the Messenger bot, Jugnoo uses the

open source project Grafana for its infrastructure monitoring, and the JavaScript library D3.js to enable various dynamic data visualisations. "We like using open source products wherever we can, and it is a fairly reasonable approach," Agarwal asserted.

Apart from using community-based solutions to

enable its key services, Jugnoo is leveraging the power of open source in its organisation as well. The startup has deployed Odoo for its HR operations. It is also planning to switch completely from proprietary offerings like Tally and SAP ERP to Odoo in the near future.

Strong community support is vital

"A lot of organisations are currently using Odoo for their business processes as it is cheaper and has a strong community support. We liked its implementation for HR, and since we are small at this point, it will be relatively easy for us to transition ultimately to Odoo for other business processes too,"

Agarwal said.

Deploying open source technologies is not always a breeze, though. Agarwal mentioned that certain finishing touches are sometimes missing in open source solutions. "If the software does not have well-managed community support, it is often problematic to use and hence not recommended," he added.

However, Jugnoo addresses this challenge by using solutions that are backed by fairly strong communities.

